

Connectify

Circles

20

26

Mission and Vision

MISSION

Make forming new friendships easier by creating structured, low-pressure opportunities for people to meet and build relationships.

VISION

A social environment where online connections naturally lead to real-world relationships — built on shared activities, not passive scrolling.

The Core Problems

01

Despite being online 24/7, college students feel isolated and struggle to form new friendships

02

No structured, low-pressure pathway from shared interest → real-world connection

03

Existing platforms optimize for content consumption, not community building

Campus Transitioners

These students are new to the campus environment. They're highly motivated to make friends and have a low existing network. Who they are:

- Freshmen
- Transfer Students
- International Students

Core Problem: They don't know many people yet and lack built-in social structure.

What they care about:

- Immediate belonging
- Structured events (so it's not awkward).



Busy & Isolated Achievers

Busy & Isolated achievers are students with little time and low exposure to social opportunities. They have high campus presence but low social integration. Who they are:

- Commuter Students
- STEM-heavy majors with intense workloads
- Student-athletes
- Students working part-time jobs

Core Problem: Time scarcity limits organic social interactions.

What they care about:

- Efficiency
- Small groups (not big social events)



Social Plateau Students

Social plateau students are those who have established a network of friends, but are socially stagnant. Who they are:

- Sophomores - Seniors
- Students with stable friend groups
- Students social life revolves around 3-5 close friends

Core Problem: They want new connections but feel awkward or hesitant to “start over”. These students have a share sentiment; “I already have friends, but i don't really meet anyone new”.

What they care about:

- Expanding beyond their current bubble
- Not disrupting existing friend groups



Socially Hesitant Connectors

Socially hesitant connectors are those who face a psychological barrier to social interactions. They want connection but experience anxiety or friction.

Who they are:

- Introverts
- Students with mild social anxiety
- Students who dislike large events
- Students tired of “networking”

Core Problem: They seek connection but avoid high-uncertainty environments. These students have a common sentiment; “I’d go if I knew someone there”.

What they care about:

- Psychological safety
- Structured format



Coterminal Students

Coterminal students are juniors or seniors recently admitted to their coterm, primarily socially tied to undergraduate circles, and are beginning graduate coursework. Who they are:

- Students older than traditional undergraduates
- Students who took gap years
- Students with high academic load
- They highly limit their social network to other coterms

Core Problem: They feel socially misaligned with younger students, and their academic intensity limits their social network.

What they care about:

- Maturity alignment
- Intentional community



Early testing shows strong student demand for structured small-group meetups

We spoke with **13 Stanford students** about making new friends. What students reported:

- **62%** said they **avoid events if they do not know someone attending**
- **75%** said they **would try an app** that matched them into a small group with a planned activity

Takeaway: Students are lacking low-pressure structures that make meeting new people easier.

The Problem

Students are constantly around other people and online all the time, but a lot of them still struggle to make real new friends. It is not that there are not enough people. It is that there are not enough comfortable, low-pressure ways to actually connect.

What We're Seeing

- Students feel awkward going to events alone
- Many avoid approaching established friend groups
- “I’d go if I knew more people there.”
- “I don’t want [the interaction] to feel forced.”
- Current platforms help people find events but do not make showing up easier

Why It Matters

- Feeling like you belong affects mental health and academic performance
- Many students feel isolated even on busy campuses
- Without support, it’s easy for students to stay confined to their existing social circles

MVP

Our solution is **Circles**

- Participants fill out a short form about their interests (hobbies, personality, schedule, major, etc.).
- The algorithm matches groups of 4-5 people who are compatible and automatically books an activity for you (a dinner reservation, mini golf, bowling, escape room, etc.), as well as creating a group chat to coordinate.
- Incorporated feedback from users: prefer multiple people in a group rather than one-on-one; prefer a pre-booked activity.

Date Drop validates the model. Circles expands it beyond dating.

Market Validation

- Date Drop successfully connects nearby people through structured meetups
- Demonstrates demand for platforms that reduce the friction of meeting someone new

The Gap

- Most students are not looking for dating
- Existing platforms help people find events but not show up comfortably

Circles has the same structured meetup model, but with a focus on friendship and small groups rather than one-on-one dating.

Spring 2026 Circles are open ✨

Meet your next **best** **friends.**

Circles matches you with a small group of students who share your interests. One form, one activity, endless possibilities.

Join the next Circle

How it works

Let's start with the basics

Tell us a little about yourself.

First name

Alex

Year

Freshman

Sophomore

Junior

Senior

Major

Computer Science

← Back

Next →

What are you into?

Pick at least 2 interests.

Music

Sports

Gaming

Cooking

Art

Film

Reading

Hiking

Photography

Dance

Tech

Fashion

Travel

Anime

Board Games

Yoga

Volunteering

Comedy

← Back

Next →

Your vibe

Help us understand your personality.

Introvert

Extrovert

Planner

Spontaneous

Next →

When & what?

When are you free and what sounds fun?

Availability

Mon

Tue

Wed

Thu

Fri

Sat

Sun

Activity types

Food & Drinks

Outdoor Adventure

Board Games

Arts & Crafts

Movie Night

Sports

Cooking Together

Explore Campus

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Next →

One last thing

What's something you're irrationally passionate about?

I could talk about the history of fonts for hours...

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Find my Circle ✓

Your Circle is here!

Meet the amazing people you've been matched with.



Jordan

Junior · Psychology

Music Hiking Film



Priya

Sophomore · Biology

Cooking Yoga Art



Marcus

Senior · English

Film Comedy Music



Lily

Freshman · Design

Art Photography Travel

YOUR ACTIVITY

Dinner Night at Zareen's

📅 Saturday, April 12

🕒 6:30 PM

📍 365 S California Ave, Palo Alto, CA 94306

💬 Open Group Chat



Zareen's Circle

5 members

Circles Bot

Welcome to your Circle! Here's a conversation starter: What's everyone most excited about this quarter?

Jordan

Hey everyone!! I'm so hyped for this. I'm excited about the new music festival on campus

Priya

Hi!! Same, I've been wanting to meet more people outside my classes. Also I heard dinner at Zareen's is going to be amazing

Say something nice...





How did it go?

Dinner at Zareen's · April 12

Rate your night



Glad you had fun!

Would you hang with this group again?

100% yes

Maybe

Probably not

Best part of the night?

The butter chicken was incredible...

Next: Share a Moment

Skip & finish



Share your Moment

Dinner at Zareen's · April 12

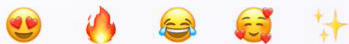


Add a photo

Share a moment from your night

What made tonight special?

Vibe check



Sharing with your Zareen's Circle



Share Moment

← Back to survey

GTM: Launch Strategy

1. Campus Pilots (Months 1-4):

- Launch at 3–5 universities (Stanford, Berkeley, UCLA)
- Partner with orientation teams, student government, and orgs to seed users
- Key metric: $\geq 70\%$ of matched groups show up to their activity

2. Organic Flywheel (Months 5-8):

- Increase signups with word-of-mouth and a referral mechanic (“Join waitlist at your school”)
- Key metric: each Circle generates 2–3 new Connectify signups

3. Monetization (Months 9-12):

- Sign 20+ venue partners; launch tiered subscription (\$99–\$499/mo) with a 10–15% affiliate commission on all Circle bookings
- Launch Sponsored Circles with 3–5 anchor brands who fund activity costs

Business Impact

Direct Revenue

- Venue partners pay \$99–\$499/mo to be featured as Circle activities
- 10–15% affiliate commission on every booking placed through the app
- Target: \$800K Year 1 across subscriptions and commissions

Ecosystem Value

- Moments: post-meetup prompt creates a natural UGC opportunity
- Pre-meetup chat rooms are hosted in RealTalk

Vision Alignment

- Connectify's vision is "a world where online connections naturally lead to real-world relationships" — Circles directly delivers on this vision

Required Resources

Funding

Employee compensation

Marketing budget — ads, flyers, street team

Venue partnerships — subsidize activity costs

Tools

Matching algorithm — creates most compatible groups

Group chat — coordinates meetups within Circles

Team Roles

1 PM

1 EM

Frontend/backend engineers

Designers

2 campus ambassadors per school

1 data analyst

Partnerships

Campus street team — builds initial user population

Venue partners — host activity locations at a lower cost, university organizations

Learnings

1. A product idea only becomes viable once a sustainable business model emerges alongside the user value
2. The loudest users aren't necessarily the most important users, especially with a product designed to reduce loneliness.
3. Interest matching matters, but not as much as having an event planned.

THANK YOU!